

STENANTHIUM

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MELANTHIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering bulbs. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Needs an open, sunny position in any well-drained soil. In cool areas, plant in a warm, sheltered site in light soil that does not dry out excessively. Propagate by seed in fall or by division in spring.

S. angustifolium. See *S. gramineum*.

S. gramineum, syn. *S. angustifolium*.

Summer-flowering bulb. H to 5ft (1.5m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). Has long, narrowly strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves. Stem produces a dense, branched, often arching spike of fragrant, star-shaped, white or green flowers, each ½–¾in (1–1.5cm) across. Z9–11

STENOCACTUS

SYN. ECHINOFOSSULOCACTUS

CACTACEAE

Genus of spherical, perennial cacti with spiny, green stems that have very narrow, wavy ribs. Frost tender. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Water well during the growing season, much less when dormant in winter as it may rot off. Propagate by seed in spring or summer.

S. coptonogonus illus. p.487.

S. crispatus, syn. *Echinofossulocactus lamellosus*. Spherical, perennial cactus. H and S 3in (8cm). Green stem has 30–35 ribs. Bears funnel-shaped, flesh-colored or red flowers, ½–1¼in (1–3cm) across, from the crown in spring. Has flattened upper radial spines, shorter, more rounded lower ones and longer, rounded central spines with darker tips. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

S. lamellosus. See *S. obvallatus*.

S. obvallatus, syn. *Echinofossulocactus pentacanthus*, *E. violaciflorus*, *Stenocactus lamellosus*, illus. p.484.

STENOCARPUS

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer- and fall-flowering shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and foliage. Frost tender. Needs full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water potted plants moderately, less in winter. Pruning is rarely necessary. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

S. sinuatus (Australian firewheel tree). Slow-growing, evergreen, upright tree. H 40ft (12m) or more, S 15ft (5m). Has lustrous, deep green leaves, each 5–10in (12–25cm) long, lance-shaped and entire or with pairs of oblong lobes. In late summer to fall, bears bottle-shaped, bright scarlet flowers, clustered like the spokes of a wheel. Z10–12 (min. 45–50°F/7–10°C)

STENOCEREUS

CACTACEAE

Genus of treelike or shrubby, perennial cacti with prominently ribbed stems often densely spined. Frost tender; below 55°F (13°C) plants may become badly marked. Needs full sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or stem cuttings in summer.

S. marginatus. See *Pachycereus marginatus*.

S. thurberi, syn. *Lemaireocereus thurberi*. Columnar, perennial cactus, branching from low down. H to 22ft (7m), S 3ft (1m). Has 5–6-ribbed, glossy, dark green stems, with very short-spined areoles set in close rows down each rib. Produces funnel-shaped, purple or pink flowers with red sepals in summer. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

Stenolobium stans. See *Tecoma stans*.

STENOMESSION

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of spring- and summer-flowering bulbs, grown for their umbels of long, often pendent, tubular flowers. Half hardy to frost tender. Needs an open, sunny situation and well-drained soil. Propagate by offsets in fall.

S. miniatum, syn. *Urceolina peruviana*, illus. p.407.

S. variegatum illus. p.407.

STENOTAPHRUM

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

S. secundatum ‘Variegatum’.

Evergreen, spreading, rhizomatous, perennial grass. H 6in (15cm), S indefinite. Almost rigid, flattened, branching stems bear linear-oblong, flat to folded, pale green leaves with ivory-white stripes. In summer, produces erect racemes of brownish-green spikelets. Used as a lawn in warm climates. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

STEPHANANDRA

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their habit, foliage, fall color, and winter shoots. Fully hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and fertile, not too dry soil. On established plants, cut out some older shoots after flowering. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by division in fall.

S. incisa. Deciduous, arching shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 10ft (3m). Ovate, deeply lobed and toothed, bright green leaves turn orange-yellow in fall and stems become rich brown in winter. Produces crowded panicles of tiny, star-shaped, greenish-white flowers in early summer. Z4–7.

‘Crispa’, H 2ft (60cm), has wavy-edged and more deeply lobed leaves.

S. tanakae illus. p.132.

STEPHANOTIS

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their scented, waxy flowers. Frost tender. Need a humus-rich, well-drained soil and partial shade in summer. Water moderately, less in cold weather. Provide stems with support. Shorten over-long or crowded stems in spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

S. floribunda (Madagascar jasmine) illus. p.460.

Sterculia acerifolia. See

Brachychiton acerifolius.

Sterculia diversifolia. See

Brachychiton populneus.

Sterculia platanifolia. See

Firmiana simplex.

STERNBERGIA

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of spring- or fall-flowering bulbs, grown for their large, crocuslike flowers. Frost hardy, but in cool areas grow against a sunny wall. Needs full sun and any well-drained, heavy or light soil that dries out in summer, when bulbs die down and need warmth and dryness. Leave undisturbed to form clumps. Propagate by division in spring or fall.

S. candida illus. p.415.

S. clusiana. Fall-flowering bulb.

H to ¾in (2cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Strap-shaped, semierect, basal, grayish-green leaves, often twisted lengthways, emerge after flowering. Stems bear erect, goblet-shaped, yellow or greenish-yellow flowers, 1½–3in (4–8cm) long. Z6–9

S. lutea. Fall-flowering bulb. H 1–6in (2.5–15cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Bears strap-shaped, semierect, basal, deep green leaves together with a funnel-shaped, bright yellow flower, 1–2½in (2.5–6cm) long, on a leafless stem. Z6–9

S. sicula. Fall-flowering bulb. H 1–3in (2.5–7cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Narrowly strap-shaped, semierect, basal, deep green leaves, each with a central, paler green stripe, emerge with flowers. Each stem bears a funnel-shaped, bright yellow flower, ¾–1¼in (2–4cm) long. Z6–9

STEWARTIA

SYN. STUARTIA

THEACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their flowers, fall color, and usually peeling bark. Fully to frost hardy. Needs a sunny site, but with roots in shade, and shelter from strong winds. Requires fertile, moist but well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Resents being transplanted. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

S. monadelpha illus. p.76.

S. pseudocamellia (illus. p.78).

Deciduous, broadly columnar tree. H 70ft (20m), S 25ft (8m). Has ornamental, peeling bark and bears roselike, white flowers in midsummer. Ovate to elliptic, finely toothed, dark green leaves turn orange and red in fall. Z5–8

S. sinensis. Deciduous, broadly conical tree. H 40ft (12m), S 22ft (7m). Has peeling bark and ovate or elliptic, toothed, dark green leaves, turning brilliant red in fall. Bears roselike, fragrant, white flowers in midsummer. Z5–8

STIGMAPHYLLON

MALPIGIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their clusters of 5-petaled flowers. Frost tender. Fertile, well-drained soil is needed, with partial shade in summer. Water freely when in full growth, less in low temperatures. Provide

stems with support. Thin out crowded stems in spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

S. ciliatum illus. p.464.

STIPA

GRAMINEAE/POACEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

S. arundinacea. See *Anemanthele lessoniana*.

S. calamagrostis illus. p.286.

S. gigantea (Golden oats) illus. p.287.

S. tenuissima illus. p.288.

STOKESIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of one species of summer-flowering, evergreen, perennial, grown for its long-lasting flower heads, which are good for cutting. Fully hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil.

Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.

S. laevis illus. p.269. **‘Blue Star’** is an evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H and S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Bears cornflowerlike, pale blue flower heads, singly at stem tips in summer. Has narrowly lance-shaped, basal, mid-green leaves, slightly spiny near the bases and with pale greenish white midribs. Z5–9

STOMATIUM

AIZOACEAE

Genus of mat-forming, perennial succulents with short stems, each bearing 4–6 pairs of solid, 3-angled or semicylindrical leaves, often with toothed edges and incurved tips. Frost tender. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

S. agninum. Mat-forming, perennial succulent. H 2in (5cm), S 3ft (1m) or more. Has solid, 3-angled or semicylindrical, soft gray-green leaves, 1½–2in (4–5cm) long, often without teeth. In summer, fragrant, daisylike, yellow flowers, ¾–2in (2–5cm) across, open in evening. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

S. patulum. Mat-forming, perennial succulent. H 1¼in (3cm), S 3ft (1m). Has semicylindrical, gray-green leaves, each ¾in (2cm) long, with rough dots and 2–9 teethlike tubercles on upper surface. Bears fragrant, daisylike, pale yellow flowers, ¾in (2cm) across, in evening in summer. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

Strangweja spicata. See *Bellevalia hyacinthoides*.

Stranvaesia. See *Photinia*.

STRATIOTES

HYDROCHARITACEAE

Genus of one species of semievergreen, perennial, submerged, free-floating water plant, grown for its foliage. Fully hardy. Requires sun. Grows in any depth of cool water. Thin plants as required. Propagate by separating young plants from runners in summer.

S. aloides (Water soldier) illus. p.435.